

Palau International Ship Registry



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MARINE CIRCULAR 190.1

To: ALL SHIPOWNERS, MANAGERS, MASTERS, AND REGISTRATION OFFICERS OF MERCHANT SHIPS AND RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATIONS.

Subject: APPLICATION OF ANNEX 14 OF THE CODE OF SAFE PRACTICE FOR CARGO STOWAGE AND SECURING (CSS CODE)

1. Reference

- 1.1 MSC.1/Circ.1352/Rev.1 – Annex 14 of the CSS Code (Guidance on Providing Safe Working Conditions for Securing Containers on Deck)
- 1.2 MSC.1/Circ.1353 – Revised Guidelines for Preparation of the Cargo Securing Manual

2. Purpose

- 2.1 The purpose of this Marine Circular is to provide information and guidance to Shipowners, Managers, and Masters on the application of the new Annex 14 of the CSS Code for new and existing ships designed and fitted for the carriage of containers on deck.

3. Applicability

- 3.1 New Ships: New ships, the keels of which are laid on or after January 1st 2015, shall apply the new Annex 14, including provision of a cargo safe access plan in the Cargo Securing Manual. Concerns in applying Annex 14, should be brought to the attention of this Administration.
- 3.2 Existing ships:
 - 3.2.1 Shipowners of existing ships, the keels of which were laid or which are at a similar stage of construction before January 1st 2015 are encouraged to apply Section 4.4 (Training and familiarization), Section 7.1 (Introduction), Section 7.3 (Maintenance); and Section 8 (Specialized Container Safety Design) of new Annex 14 by the first survey related to the Safety Construction on or after January 1st 2016.
 - 3.2.2 Shipowners are encouraged to apply the principles of relevant guidance contained in the new Annex 14, Section 6 (Design) and section 7.2 (Operational procedures), as far as practicable, with the understanding that existing ships would not be required to be enlarged or undergo other major structural modifications. As minimum, existing ships, should comply by the first scheduled dry dock survey on or after January 1st 2016 as follows:
 - a. Section 6.1.3 providing for safe container lashing operations in spaces between containers stows;



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- b. Section 63.2.1 providing non-slip surfaces on decks used for movement about the ship and all passageways and stairs, delineating walkways by painted lines or pictorial signs, highlighting protrusions on access ways that may give rise to a trip hazard;
- c. Section 6.2.2.5 providing toe boards (or kick plates) around the sides of elevated lashing bridges or platforms; and section 6.2.2.6 providing for closing of openings in lashing platforms through which people can fall;
- d. Section 6.2.3.3. providing for fences and handrails to be highlighted with a contrasting color to the background;
- e. Section 6.2.3.4 providing for protection of unguarded edges on athwartships cargo security walkways when the hatch cover is removed;
- f. Section 6.2.4.13 providing for handholds at the top of the ladder to enable safe access to the platform and section 6.2.4.14 providing for manhole openings that may present a fall hazard to be highlighted in contrasting color around the rim of the opening; and
- g. Section 7.2.1.2 and 7.2.1.3 related to protection of openings necessary for the operation of the ship, which are not protected by fencing.

3.3 Concerns in applying the above should be brought to the attention to this Administration.

4. Contact

- 4.1 Any inquiries concerning the subject for this Marine Circular should be directed to the Palau Ship Registry Administrator at technical@palaureg.com

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